‘I’ll have to call you back in a minute.’

I think we’re lucky. Victoria and I are as comfortable talking on the phone as we are face to face. I know I hate being away from her and the boys but it’s that much easier because, if we’re on the line, it’s intimate and easy enough between us that I feel like we’re connected, even if our words are having to be bumped across continents. We feel close enough, anyway, to keep me going until I get home. Life gets so intense and so strange sometimes that, if I couldn’t ring the one person who understands it all, I’m not sure I’d always make it home with my head in one piece. Five minutes on the phone with Victoria can make sense of what’s going on at my end for me, sort out the strangest problem and calm the biggest crisis. The trust and love that make it work like that are the same in any marriage. Most people’s conversations, though, can happen across the dinner table when they get in from work. If I need to talk to Victoria, I’ll often have to find out an international dialing code first.

Of course, with the life we live, the important thing is that Victoria and I are in it together. We both know what it’s like to be successful in what we do in our careers. Partly because we’re a couple, we know what comes with a certain level of fame and an unbelievable amount of attention. We’re lucky we have great people around us: family and professional advisers who relieve some of the strain, help us find our way through living the public side of our lives and careers. When it comes down to it, though, it’s me and the missus. Every now and again, we’ll have to sit down and pinch ourselves, look at what’s happening together:

‘What’s going on right now? What might be just around the corner?’

Whether those conversations happen over the phone or face to face, the important thing is that they happen. Life gets crazy sometimes. We’ll see things, be asked to do things, be presented with challenges that we could never have foreseen turning up even a couple of years ago. Truth be told, we both enjoy the unpredictability of it all; Victoria even more than me. There’s always something new going on. It’s important to try to keep things under control, for our own and the boys’ sakes, but every now and again—whether it’s studio time in the States or a transfer, out of the blue, to a new club in a different country—things feel like they take on a life of their own. And leave us just hanging on to the slipstream. We have our tricky moments, like anybody else would. But having each other, I think, stops me or Victoria getting overwhelmed by it all.